

Business Plan — FirstInLine (working name)

AI Job-Hunt Command Center for Sales Professionals Founder:
Joseph Goydish II | Date: 2026-08-22 | Status: Pre-launch (MVP built)

1. Executive Summary

FirstInLine is a subscription web app that treats a job search like a sales pipeline. It finds B2B sales job postings **before they flood** (direct ATS boards, stealth startups, VC portfolio boards, LinkedIn hiring posts), scores each lead against the user's resume using AI, and generates personalized outreach messages that get replies.

The wedge: generic job-search tools (Teal, Jobright, Huntr) show the same 500-applicant postings to everyone. FirstInLine finds early-signal opportunities and does the personalization work that actually moves the needle — for the one audience that understands pipeline thinking: salespeople.

Model: freemium SaaS. Free tier (throttled, weekly runs) → Pro \$29/mo (daily runs, unlimited leads, all outreach features). Launch price \$19/mo.

Ask: none external — bootstrapped, launchable for < \$50 (existing VPS, existing Oxylabs credits, domain + Stripe only).

2. Problem

1. **Discovery is broken:** job seekers use the same boards and see the same postings, often applying days after posting — competing with 300-500+ applicants.

2. **Outreach is ignored:** recruiters receive hundreds of generic "motivated self-starter" messages. Personalization is the difference between a reply and a delete, but most people don't do it because it's tedious.
3. **No pipeline thinking:** job seekers don't track their search like a sales funnel — no follow-up cadence, no pipeline stages, no measurement. Salespeople know this is exactly how you win.
4. **Stealth/early roles are invisible:** the best opportunities (founding SDR at a YC startup, a manager posting "we're hiring" on LinkedIn) are the hardest to find — they sit on direct ATS pages and VC boards, not Indeed.

3. Solution

A web app that runs the user's job search like a sales motion:

- **Early-signal discovery engine** — targeted scraper (Oxylabs) across 4+ channels: direct Greenhouse/Ashby ATS postings, LinkedIn hiring posts, VC/YC portfolio boards, regional tech ecosystems.
- **AI scoring** — Gemini reads each lead against the user's resume and outputs a match score (90-99), clean company name, and "why you fit."
- **AI outreach generator** — a 150-character LinkedIn connection note + a short cold email, personalized per company, with placeholders.
- **Application CRM** — pipeline board: Saved → Applied → Replied → Interview → Offer.
- **Weekly digest** — email summary of new early-signal leads.
- **User profiles** — paste resume, pick target queries (role type, industry, location, remote).

4. Market

TAM/SAM/SOM (conservative)

- **TAM:** ~4M US sales professionals (Bureau of Labor Statistics: sales & related occupations). Job seekers at any given time: ~10-15% → ~500K.
- **SAM:** tech/SaaS salespeople actively job hunting (SDR/BDR/AE): ~150-250K US.
- **SOM (year 1):** 500-1,000 paying users via organic + community distribution.

Competition

Tool	What it does	Gap FirstInLine exploits
Teal	Resume builder + job tracker	Generic boards, no early-signal, no outreach
Jobright	AI job matching	Late discovery, generic outreach
Huntr	Job application tracker	No discovery engine, no AI outreach
Sonara	Auto-apply	Spray-and-pray, no personalization
Simplify	Auto-fill applications	Speed, not signal
PathWise	Career coaching	Not a tool

Positioning: "The salesperson's job search tool." We don't compete on volume — we compete on signal + personalization. The ICP is the marketing: salespeople understand "pipeline," "ICP," "outreach" instantly.

5. Business Model

Pricing

Tier	Price	Includes
Free	\$0	5 leads/run, weekly runs, basic tracker
Pro	\$29/mo (\$19 launch)	Daily runs, unlimited leads, AI outreach, digest, priority support
Annual	\$228/yr (2 months free)	Everything in Pro

Unit economics (targets)

- **Data cost per Pro user/month:** ~\$1-2 (Oxylabs credits + Gemini).
Daily runs × ~4 credits/run × ~\$0.003-0.01/credit + Gemini pennies.
- **Gross margin:** > 90% at scale.
- **CAC:** \$0-15 (organic/community-led; referral program).
- **LTV (12-mo avg retention):** ~\$228-348. LTV:CAC > 15:1.
- **Churn reality:** job seekers churn when hired — that's the success outcome. Mitigate with referral gifts + alumni network.

Revenue scenarios (Year 1)

Scenario	Paying users	MRR	ARR
Conservative	300	\$5,700	\$68K
Base	600	\$11,400	\$137K
Stretch	1,200	\$22,800	\$274K

6. Go-to-Market

Phase 0 — Validation (Week 1)

- Landing page + waitlist (one-pager pitch)
- 10 conversations with real salespeople → gate: 5 "I'd pay \$19-29/mo"

Phase 1 — Launch (Weeks 2-6)

- Build MVP (productize existing scripts → web app)
- Invite waitlist, dogfood (founder's own job hunt = live case study)
- **Content engine:** founder posts the journey on LinkedIn — he IS the ICP. "I built an AI tool to find my next SDR role" is the story.

Phase 2 — Distribution (Week 8+)

- Communities: r/sales, r/SDR, r/techsales, SDR Discords, tech sales Slack groups
- Referral program: free month per referral; hired users gift months to their network
- Product Hunt launch + sales-coach/community partnerships
- **SEO:** "SDR job search," "how to find B2B sales jobs," "best job search tools for sales" content

Phase 3 — Expand (Month 3+)

- Verticals: AE, CS, marketing, design, engineering
- Sources: Lever, Workable, SmartRecruiters, YC/VC APIs
- Features: interview prep, salary intel, company research packs, auto-apply drafts

7. Operations & Tech

Stack (boring on purpose)

- **Backend:** Python (existing scripts) → FastAPI service
- **Data:** SQLite (start) → Postgres (scale)
- **AI:** Google Gemini API (existing key)
- **Scraping:** Oxylabs Realtime API (existing account, ~893 credits)
- **Frontend:** existing dashboard HTML → React/Next (only after validation)
- **Auth:** magic-link (email OTP) — no password storage
- **Payments:** Stripe Checkout (no subscription engine at first)
- **Email:** Resend (free tier)
- **Deploy:** this VPS, Docker, Caddy/nginx + Cloudflare
- **Cost to launch:** < \$50

Data & ToS compliance (critical)

- Scrape via Oxylabs (licensed data provider) — never resell raw scraped datasets
- Position product as "discovery + assistant," not a data broker
- Respect robots.txt, rate limits, per-source terms
- Privacy: user resumes are sensitive — encrypt at rest, never train on user data without consent, delete-on-request

8. Roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
0. Validate	Week 1	Name, domain, landing, 10 interviews, 5 yeses
1. Productize	Weeks 2-3	Secrets→.env, core package, multi-user, auth
2. MVP	Weeks 4-6	Feed UI, outreach generator, tracker, digest, deploy

Phase	Timeline	Deliverables
3. Monetize	Weeks 6-7	Stripe, free/pro tiers, usage caps
4. Launch	Week 8	Waitlist → paid, Product Hunt, community push
5. Scale	Month 3+	Verticals, sources, AI upgrades, frontend rebuild

9. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation
Scraping ToS (LinkedIn/ATS)	High	Oxylabs licensed provider; no raw resale; assistant positioning
Oxylabs credit cost	Medium	Dedup cache (built), usage caps, per-user throttling
Churn on hire	Medium	Referral gifts, alumni network, "success = churn" framing
Crowded market	Medium	Early-signal wedge + sales-native positioning; don't compete on volume
Founder distraction (job hunt)	Medium	Dogfood: the job hunt IS the demo; product ships while he searches
Single point of failure (one dev)	Low	Boring stack, documented scripts, freelance frontend later

10. Team

Joseph Goydish II — Founder. 3.5+ years B2B cybersecurity SaaS sales (Cyberbit, FortifyData); self-taught security researcher with 5 NVD-published Apple CVEs (CISA KEV, CVSS 10.0); D1 NCAA athlete (discipline, coachability, composure under pressure). Built the entire MVP solo. He is the ICP, the first customer, and the marketing story.

11. Financial Plan (Year 1, base case)

Costs

Item	Monthly	Notes
VPS	\$0	existing
Oxylabs	\$20-40	scales with users; monitor
Gemini	\$5-15	pennies per run
Domain + email	\$2	
Stripe fees	2.9% + 30¢	variable
Total fixed	~\$30-60/mo	

Revenue (base case)

- 600 paying users × \$19 avg = \$11,400 MRR by month 12
- Ramp: 0 → 50 → 150 → 300 → 450 → 600 (organic + community)
- **Year 1 ARR: ~\$137K, gross margin > 85%**

12. The Founder's Edge (why this wins or dies)

Wins if: the early-signal wedge is real (it is — the harvest proves it), the ICP responds to the sales-native pitch (they will — it's how they think), and the founder ships fast while living the problem (he is).

Dies if: validation shows salespeople won't pay (Phase 0 gate catches this before cost), or Oxylabs/ToS kills the discovery engine (mitigated by provider + positioning).

Bottom line: a \$50 launch, a founder who is the customer, and a wedge no incumbent owns. Worst case: a great portfolio piece and a better job hunt. Best case: a real company.